

Ingenco Holdings, v. OPAL Fuels

Renewable-natural-gas generation from landfill or digester gas under U.S. Patent No. 7,731,779, asserted across six operating-company defendants and facilities.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-20	D. Del.	1:26-cv-01061	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Ingenco Holdings, LLC v. OPAL Fuels LLC et al.
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FORUM / DOCKET	D. Del. / 1:26-cv-01061
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-20 / patent infringement
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

Ingenco Holdings, LLC v. OPAL Fuels LLC et al., No. 1:26-cv-01061, filed 2026-08-20 in D. Del..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Emily S. DiBenedetto - Shaw Keller LLP; named matter counsel. The public docket names DiBenedetto as counsel for the plaintiff and shows her filing service papers immediately after initiation. Selecting the named working counsel as likely purchaser is an analytical inference from that role.

edibenedetto@shawkeller.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Renewable-natural-gas generation from landfill or digester gas under U.S. Patent No. 7,731,779, asserted across six operating-company defendants and facilities.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. 7,731,779](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 What sequence of collection, conditioning, compression, separation, upgrading, and energy use is required by the asserted claims?

What sequence of collection, conditioning, compression, separation, upgrading, and energy use is required by the asserted claims?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 How do the defendants' landfill and digester facilities handle methane, CO₂, H₂S, moisture, siloxanes, oxygen/nitrogen, and product-gas specifications?

How do the defendants' landfill and digester facilities handle methane, CO₂, H₂S, moisture, siloxanes, oxygen/nitrogen, and product-gas specifications?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 What pre-2007 landfill-gas and digester-gas systems disclosed the claimed arrangement, and which operating evidence is needed to test infringement and damages?

What pre-2007 landfill-gas and digester-gas systems disclosed the claimed arrangement, and which operating evidence is needed to test infringement and damages?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Morton A. Barlaz

Distinguished University Professor, North Carolina State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for landfill-gas generation, collection efficiency, methane mass balance, emissions, and operating conditions.

RELEVANT WORK

Leading landfill researcher with recent work on gas-collection efficiency and simulated landfill gas behavior.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic/emissions orientation may need a process-equipment specialist for gas upgrading hardware.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | barlaz@ncsu.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Jean E. Bogner

Research Professor Emerita, University of Illinois Chicago

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for landfill methane generation, recovery/utilization, gas transport, oxidation, and commercial projects.

RELEVANT WORK

Decades of field measurement, modeling, and U.S./international landfill-gas recovery work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Emerita status and potential age of some field projects require availability/current-practice diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jbogner@uic.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Rebecca Larson

Associate Professor, University of Wisconsin-Madison

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for anaerobic digestion, manure/food waste, biogas, waste-to-energy, and facility performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Research and extension cover biological waste treatment and biogas production from anaerobic digestion.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

More digester-focused than landfill-gas collection and upgrading.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | rebecca.larson@wisc.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Babu Joseph

Professor of Chemical, Biological and Materials Engineering, University of South Florida

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for conversion of biogas/landfill gas, reforming, catalysis, process control, and system engineering.

RELEVANT WORK

Researches landfill-gas-to-liquids, catalysts, process intensification, and complex-system engineering.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Liquids/conversion research may be adjacent to, rather than identical with, the claimed RNG process.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | bjoseph@usf.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Ruihong Zhang

Professor of Biological and Agricultural Engineering, UC Davis

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for anaerobic digestion, co-digestion, biogasification, feedstock characterization, and scale-up.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes extensively on biogas from manure, food waste, rice straw, and phased digesters.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Digester feedstocks are distinct from some landfill-gas facilities in the defendant portfolio.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | rzhang@ucdavis.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Stephanie Lansing

Professor of Environmental Science and Technology, University of Maryland

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for biogas production, anaerobic digestion, H₂S removal, nutrient capture, economics, and field systems.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads a bioenergy lab and has full-scale biotrickling-filter work for digester-gas cleanup.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic research may not cover every commercial upgrading train or patent claim limitation.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | slansing@umd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Stefan Grimberg

Professor of Civil and Environmental Engineering, Clarkson University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for anaerobic digestion of food/farm waste, biogas generation, and environmental process design.

RELEVANT WORK

Publicly designated university contact for anaerobic digestion and biogas research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited contact page provides limited publication detail; deeper CV diligence is needed.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | grimberg@clarkson.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Daniel Andersen

Associate Professor of Agricultural and Biosystems Engineering, Iowa State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for anaerobic digesters, manure treatment, nutrient recovery, monitoring, and economic evaluation.

RELEVANT WORK

Research integrates biological/chemical/physical treatment and carbon/nutrient accounting in farm systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Agricultural systems emphasis is not landfill-gas specific.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | dsa@iastate.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Tyler Radniecki

Professor of Chemical, Biological and Environmental Engineering, Oregon State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for anaerobic-digester microbiomes, methane production, process performance, and biological treatment.

RELEVANT WORK

Current projects shape digester microbiomes to enhance methane yield.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Microbial-process focus may be less useful for downstream gas upgrading and patent-system mapping.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | tyler.radniecki@oregonstate.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Joseph Usack

Assistant Professor of Food Science and Technology, University of Georgia

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for anaerobic digestion, methane-platform upgrading, scale-up, commercialization, technoeconomics, and systems integration.

RELEVANT WORK

Develops and scales microbial bioprocesses and publishes on upgrading anaerobic digestion within the energy economy.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Early-career relative to senior landfill specialists and less landfill-specific.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ju71764@uga.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/delaware/dedce/1%3A2026cv01061/94324>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://shawkeller.com/attorneys/emily-s-dibenedetto/>

Public technical context source: <https://patents.justia.com/patent/7731779>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

No attorney or expert was contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts were not checked.